# DECLARATION OF NAOMI GRACE ECKHARDT

I, Naomi Grace Eckhardt, declare as follows:

1. I am a United States citizen. I was born in Corpus Christi, Texas, on September 27, 1994. I live at 4127 Sendero Bluff, San Antonio, TX 78245 with my husband, Ezequiel Tomás Barrientos Cifuentes, and our two children, Lucía, who is 9, and Gabriel, who is 4.

2. Ezequiel and I met in San Antonio in 2014, and we were married on March 19, 2016. I filed an I-130 petition for him in October 2024, and it was approved in September 2025.

3. In February 2024, when he was two, Gabriel was diagnosed with autism spectrum disorder at the developmental clinic of a children's hospital in San Antonio. He says only a few words. He goes to applied behavior analysis (ABA) therapy about 20 hours a week at a center across town, and to speech therapy twice a week. His therapists tell us that these early years matter most.

4. I teach special education full-time at Laurel Heights Elementary School in the Mission Creek Independent School District, and I cannot leave school during the day. Ezequiel runs his own framing business. He schedules his jobs so that he can drive Gabriel to therapy and pick him up four days a week, and he takes Lucía to school most mornings. My parents live in Corpus Christi, two and a half hours away, and cannot help us day to day.

5. Ezequiel earns almost as much as I do. In 2025 his business made $44,350 and my salary was $58,200. Our rent is $1,850 a month, and Gabriel's therapy copays and the gas to get him there cost about $600 a month. On my salary alone we could not pay the rent, Gabriel's care and our other bills.

6. Ezequiel's hometown is Quetzaltenango, Guatemala. I do not know whether Gabriel could get ABA therapy there. I speak very little Spanish, so I could not work as a teacher, and Lucía has never been to Guatemala.

7. I do not know what we would do if Ezequiel is not allowed to come back. Either way, our family would be broken apart. I am asking that his waiver be approved so that we can stay together.

I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the United States of America that the foregoing is true and correct.

Executed on September 28, 2026, in San Antonio, Texas.

*Naomi G. Eckhardt*

Naomi Grace Eckhardt

SPECIMEN